
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Middle Age Ulm

Forges of Ulm

Progress Edition 30

Published - 14 September 2026

Unmodded 6.37 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Middle Age Ulm: Forges of Ulm

Ulm one-page command brief

Middle Age Ulm converts resources into heavily armoured human armies, then uses recruit-anywhere Master Smiths to turn a narrow Earth and Fire base into battlefield support and forged equipment. Its forts receive 25% more resources, its smiths add local resources, and its capital produces five Earth gems each month. The result is a nation whose military and magical economies reinforce one another when forts, laboratories, troop production, and smith recruitment stay in balance.

The reliable core is compact:

- half plate offers more bodies when resources are tight;
- black plate offers exceptional mundane protection at a steep resource cost;
- pikes, shields, great weapons, flails, crossbows, and cavalry let the roster answer different physical targets;
- Sappers and Master Masons turn recruitment into siege pressure and stronger fort construction;
- Master Smiths provide fixed F1 E2, research unaffected by Drain, Forge Bonus 2, and a 20% FAES random;
- capital Priest Smiths combine F1 E2 H1 with Forge Bonus 1;
- Black Priests provide E1 H2, Inquisition, and a smaller FAES random;
- national spells add cold-iron missiles, army-wide magic-resistance support, and a late Iron Angel ritual;
- national items give Construction a strategic branch with defined jobs.

Ulm's weaknesses are equally structural. Most soldiers and mundane commanders have MR 9. The roster is slow, resource hungry, and vulnerable to attacks that bypass armour. Native magic has no dependable Water, Death, Nature, Glamour, or Blood, while Air and Astral appear only on rare randoms. Heavy recruitment can also consume the gold and resources needed to build the fort network that makes the nation scale.

Ulm evidence and ruleset

The scope is unmodded MA Ulm on the Book I 6.36 live baseline. The roster, costs, and national summary are taken from the revision-2 official manual. Random-path masks, capital sites, national spells, national items, and object identifiers are cross-checked against the pinned 6.35 Inspector export at commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc.

The two sources have different jobs. The current manual controls the player-facing roster and national rules. The pinned export resolves fields that the manual compresses or omits. Opening priorities, research branches, battlefield packages, Pretender families, and matchup choices are strategy. No live-game result is inferred from a database field when targeting, timing, stacking, or displayed cost requires engine observation.

Ulm conversion chain

```
enhanced fort resources and weapon-specific infantry
-> reliable expansion and protected borders
-> additional forts and laboratories
-> repeatable Master Smith recruitment
-> Earth buffs, national priest magic, and discounted forging
-> specialised armies, siege columns, and imported path access
-> fortified territorial gains and late ritual options
```

The chain commonly breaks in three places. Full black plate and cavalry can absorb the resources meant for expansion volume. Troop recruitment can absorb the gold meant for forts and laboratories. Smiths can be treated as generic researchers, leaving rare Air, Earth, Fire, or Astral results unlabelled and the matching spell branches unused.

Ulm national rules that shape the plan

Rule or asset	Operational consequence
Forts produce 25% more resources	Fort placement has military value beyond recruitment access; high-resource provinces become especially useful production centres.
Productivity limit +1	The Pretender design may buy more Production than an ordinary nation, but the extra scale is useful only if gold and recruitment points can consume the resources.
Drain limit +1	Ulm may take deeper Drain, and smith researchers are unhindered by it. Non-immune researchers and other magic consequences still need to be counted.
Master Smith and Priest Smith Resource Bonus +10	A recruited smith improves the province's troop capacity while serving as researcher, forger, or caster.
Master Mason	The capital can produce a Mason with Siege +30 and Castle Defence +20 in the structured record; its construction job competes with other capital recruitment.
Capital Earth income	The Forges of Ulm site supplies five Earth gems each month, supporting Earth rituals, battlefield gems, and forging.
Weak priesthood with Inquisitors	Black Acolytes supply H1, while capital Black Priests supply H2 and Inquisition. Religious operations remain concentrated in the capital queue.
Superior armour and national forging	Mundane protection is a real advantage, but armour does not answer magic resistance attacks, fatigue, armour destruction, or armour-negating damage.

The resource bonuses reward a distributed production network. They do not remove the gold cost of that network. A province that can recruit another block of black plate but cannot fund a laboratory, commander, or next fort may be producing the wrong asset for the current turn.

Ulm roster by job

Unit group	Best job	Important limit
War Dog	Cheap armoured screening, flanking pressure, and pursuit	Low HP and MR; animal leadership and losses must be managed
Infantry of Ulm in half plate	Resource-efficient line mass with shield, flail, hammer, maul, morningstar, or battleaxe variants	Protection is lower than black plate, and the correct weapon still depends on the target
Black Plate Infantry	High-protection line, bodyguard-quality mass, and attritional holding	Much higher resource cost, ordinary MR, low battlefield speed, and fatigue exposure
Pikeneer and Black Plate Pikeneer	Long-weapon line against large units, cavalry, and repel-sensitive attackers	No shield and limited value when weapon length or armour does not solve the matchup
Crossbowman	Arbalest pressure against armoured targets from behind a screen	Slow rate of fire, ordinary precision, and friendly-fire risk

Unit group	Best job	Important limit
Sapper	Siege strength, crossbow support, and campaign utility	Twenty gold and high recruitment-point demand make it a specialist, not default infantry
Guardian	Capital-only elite infantry with a Black Halberd	Capital restriction, high resources, and high recruitment-point demand limit mass
Black Knight	Armoured shock cavalry, flank threat, and mobile reserve	Sixty gold, heavy resource demand, MR 9, and separate rider-and-mount failure modes

Ulm should select armour and weapon by job. Half plate increases numbers when the resource ceiling matters. Full black plate increases protection when conventional weapons are the threat. Shields matter under missile pressure. Great weapons and the Black Halberd matter when damage and armour penetration are more important than defence. Flails matter against shields. Pikes matter against large targets and for repel interactions. None is the universal Ulmish infantry.

The armour budget

The useful recruitment question is whether black plate's extra resources prevent another soldier, crossbowman, fort, or specialist from being produced on the required turn. A mixed formation can place the most protected troops where contact is expected and use cheaper armour where frontage matters more than individual survival.

The same rule governs Black Knights. Their charge, protection, and mobility can solve a battle that infantry cannot reach in time. Buying them as ordinary line troops turns a resource advantage into a narrow and expensive queue.

Ulm commander and mage portfolio

Commander	Paths or ability	Main jobs	Recruitment warning
Commander of Ulm variants	Mundane leadership with different armour and weapons	Low-cost army command matched to the troop package	MR 9 and no magic utility; full black plate increases resource cost
Black Lord	Heavy cavalry commander, Leadership 100	Mobile command, armoured reserve, and battle leadership	Expensive and still MR 9
Spy	Stealth 60, Spy	Information, unrest reporting, and enemy-strength checks	Intelligence quality depends on position and time; it does not replace scouting or scrying
Black Acolyte	H1	Blessing, preaching, light religious support	Narrow role and no Earth path for the national priest spells
Master Smith	F1 E2, 20% FAES random, Forge Bonus 2, Resource Bonus +10	Core research, Earth support, forging, site searching, and rare-path branches	Two recruitment points; rare paths are each only 5%
Master Mason	Mason, Siege +30	Better fort construction, siege and fort defence	Capital-only commander turn
Lord Guardian	Halt Heretic +3, Leadership 100	Capital defence, leadership, and hostile-dominion pressure	Capital-only and not a mage
Black Priest	E1 H2, Inquisitor, 10% FAES random	National priest spells, preaching, Inquisition, and rare-path utility	Capital-only, two recruitment points, and no forge bonus in the pinned record
Priest Smith	F1 E2 H1, Forge Bonus 1, Resource Bonus +10	Fixed-path national priest magic, research, Earth support, and forging	Capital-only, 245 gold, and two recruitment points

The normal fort queue should be read as a capacity decision. Master Smiths are the repeatable magical engine. Mundane commanders move the troops that engine supports. The capital must choose among religious access, Mason infrastructure, elite commanders, and ordinary fort recruits; it should not be assigned one permanent queue without reference to the current bottleneck.

Reading the smith randoms

Master Smith distribution

The pinned record gives every Master Smith fixed F1 E2 and a 20% chance of one additional level chosen equally from Fire, Air, Earth, or Astral.

Final paths	Probability per recruitment
F1 E2	80%
F2 E2	5%
F1 A1 E2	5%
F1 E3	5%
F1 E2 S1	5%

The chance of recruiting at least one named rare path after n independent Master Smiths is $1 - 0.95^n$. That is about 51.2% after 14 recruits, 64.2% after 20, and 90.1% after 45. Twenty recruits are an average waiting time for a named 5% result, not a guarantee. A plan that requires A1, S1, F2, or E3 on a fixed early turn needs a backup.

Black Priest distribution

The capital-only Black Priest has fixed E1 H2 and a 10% chance of one FAES level. The four named rare results are 2.5% each.

Final paths	Probability per recruitment
E1 H2	90%
F1 E1 H2	2.5%
A1 E1 H2	2.5%
E2 H2	2.5%
E1 S1 H2	2.5%

The Priest Smith is not a random-path substitute. It has fixed F1 E2 H1, so it supplies dependable access to Iron Darts and Iron Blizzard but never becomes the rare Air or Astral result by repeated recruitment.

Every smith and Black Priest should be labelled when recruited. The label should record paths, home fort, current job, and whether the unit is reserved for a threshold spell, searching route, or forge chain. Rare paths lose strategic value when they disappear into an undifferentiated research stack.

National spells and the caster who owns them

Spell	School and requirement	Native caster	Planning use and boundary
Iron Darts	Evocation 3, E1 H1	Black Priest or Priest Smith	Low-fatigue national cold-iron missiles. The source describes special value against magical beings; formation, target selection, and actual damage still belong to battle context.
Tempering the Will	Thaumaturgy 5, E3	Master Smith or Priest Smith after Summon Earthpower; E3 Master Smith directly	National battlefield magic-resistance support. It addresses a central roster weakness but does not make MR 9 troops immune to hostile magic.
Iron Blizzard	Evocation 6, E1 H1	Black Priest or Priest Smith	A larger national cold-iron missile package with much higher fatigue. Caster count, range, fatigue recovery, and friendly-fire exposure determine whether it is worth fielding.
Contact Iron Angel	Conjuration 8, E5 S2, 25 Earth gems	No unassisted recruit	Late summon with high MR and Halt Heretic. Research alone does not create the E5 S2 caster; the exact booster, empowerment, summon, or Pretender route must be owned first.

This table distinguishes research access from caster access. Ulm can research Contact Iron Angel while still lacking any legal caster. Conversely, every normal fort can recruit the E2 smith who reaches E3 in battle through Summon Earthpower, so Tempering the Will has a much more dependable delivery route.

National item portfolio

The pinned item register separates Ulm's items into discounted designs and a restricted design. The distinction matters. A national rebate changes cost for Ulm; a restriction changes who may forge the item. Book V owns the general forging rules and the unresolved stacking ledger.

Early discounted blacksteel

Construction 1 opens the Blacksteel Sword, Blacksteel Tower Shield, Blacksteel Kite Shield, Blacksteel Helmet, Blacksteel Plate, and Blacksteel Full Plate. Most require E1; the full plate requires E2. These items let an ordinary Master Smith equip thugs, commanders, and specialists from the nation's native Earth income.

The item card should decide whether a piece solves the actual failure. More protection is useful against conventional weapons. It does not repair low MR, fatigue, elemental vulnerability, or command problems. A tower shield, kite shield, weapon, helmet, and full plate also compete for slots with non-national answers.

Later national equipment

Item	Construction and paths	Evidence-backed role
Black Halberd	Construction 3, E1	Restricted to MA and LA Ulm in the pinned record; a national two-handed weapon option

Item	Construction and paths	Evidence-backed role
Blacksteel Barding	Construction 3, E2	Discounted national mount armour
The Copper Arm	Construction 7, E3 F1	Discounted cursed item that grants extra arms; use requires a complete chassis and slot plan
Krupp's Bracers	Construction 9, E2	Discounted artifact-tier reinvigoration item

Master Smith Forge Bonus 2, Priest Smith Forge Bonus 1, national rebates, global forge modifiers, and integer rounding can interact. The final gem price remains unresolved. The live forge screen is the operational authority until the current stacking order is supported by a versioned observation record.

Ulm opening priorities

The opening has five linked jobs:

- 1

identify whether resources, gold, commander turns, or recruitment points are the immediate ceiling;
- 2

recruit the armour-and-weapon mix that answers the local independent provinces;
- 3

reserve the gold needed for the next fort and laboratory;
- 4

start a repeatable Master Smith pipeline without leaving armies leaderless;
- 5

preserve enough capital flexibility for a Mason, Priest Smith, Black Priest, Lord Guardian, or Guardian block when its specialised job becomes real.

A safe default is a protected infantry line with arbalest support, adjusted for the target. Pike weight rises against large units and cavalry. Great weapons rise against protection. Shields rise against missiles. Half plate rises when resource-limited frontage matters. Black plate rises when ordinary weapon damage is the main threat and the production centre can sustain it.

Expansion packages to evaluate from reports

Package	Intended target	Failure signal
Half-plate line plus crossbows	Ordinary infantry and armoured independents	The line collapses before the slow ranged damage pays back
Shielded black-plate line	Missile-heavy or conventional melee provinces	Resources produce too few bodies, or fatigue defeats the protection advantage
Pikes with protected flanks	Cavalry, large animals, and long-weapon matchups	Small high-Defence troops close safely and win the sustained melee
Great-weapon infantry	High-protection targets	Low Defence, missiles, or first-strike losses remove the damage dealers
Black Knight reserve	Weak flanks, exposed ranged troops, and time-sensitive reinforcement	Anti-large weapons, armour-negating damage, or attrition consume an irreplaceably expensive package

These are decision templates, not published expansion counts. Exact party sizes remain open because the map, scales, formations, commander, independent type, and combat rolls change the answer. No new runtime test preparation is required to use the dossier's economic and matchup logic.

Ulm research response tree

Trunk: make fixed E2 recruitment useful

Enchantment 1
-> Construction 2
-> Conjuratation 3

- Enchantment 1 gives Strength of Giants to fixed E2 smiths.
- Construction 2 gives Temper Armors and completes the first ordinary equipment tier.
- Conjuratation 3 gives Summon Earthpower, raising an E2 smith to E3 during battle.

This is a capacity trunk, not a mandatory order. An immediate armoured enemy may justify Alteration. Magical beings may justify early Iron Darts. A fort network that needs equipment may value Construction first. Every research choice should name the current caster, army, and expected deployment turn.

Branch A: Earth control and armour reduction

Alteration 3 gives Earth Meld to E2. Alteration 4 gives Destruction to an E3 caster, which an ordinary Master Smith can reach after Summon Earthpower. Alteration 5 adds Maws of the Earth for E3 and a gem. Later Marble Warriors and Iron Warriors strengthen protection packages, but their caster thresholds, fatigue, and exposure must be scheduled with the army.

This branch is strongest when conventional Ulmish damage is losing to protection or when the line needs Earth control to keep enemies in the kill zone. It is weaker when the enemy ignores armour, attacks MR, or forces the smiths to move too far from the troops they support.

Branch B: national priest missiles and MR support

Evocation 3 opens Iron Darts for Black Priests and Priest Smiths. Thaumaturgy 5 opens Tempering the Will for E3. Evocation 6 opens Iron Blizzard. The first branch is capital-caster limited even when the research is cheap; the second can be delivered by repeatable E2 smiths after Summon Earthpower.

Do not read the national spell list as one automatic queue. Iron Darts and Iron Blizzard are most attractive when their cold-iron profile and ranged delivery solve the observed target. Tempering the Will is most attractive when hostile MR checks threaten expensive low-MR soldiers.

Branch C: broad Earth force multiplication

Enchantment 5 gives Weapons of Sharpness to E3. Construction 6 gives Legions of Steel to E4 and a gem. An E3-random Master Smith reaches E4 through Summon Earthpower; ordinary E2 smiths need another real step. High Earth rituals such as Riches from Beneath, Forge of the Ancients, and Earth Blood Deep Well are planning endpoints, not native guarantees. Their E5 or E6 caster and large gem cost must be built before the research can pay back.

Branch D: rare Fire, Air, and Astral results

- An F2 Master Smith can cast Phoenix Power and reach F3 for stronger Fire battle magic such as Falling Fires or Summon Fire Elemental.
- An A1 Master Smith can combine Air with the fixed Earth base. After Summon Earthpower it reaches E3 A1, including the path threshold for Rain of Stones; that spell's danger to Ulm's own human army makes delivery and protection part of the package.
- An S1 Master Smith opens basic Astral searching and utility, but S1 is not a communion engine or the S2 half of Contact Iron Angel by itself.
- An E3 Master Smith reaches E4 through Summon Earthpower and owns thresholds that ordinary smiths do not.

These are portfolio branches. Researching one before recruiting the matching 5% result converts certainty into hope. Record the rare mage first, then select the branch.

Ulm battlefield packages

Armoured line with Earth support

A mundane commander moves the infantry while one or more Master Smiths supply reachable buffs. The screen's armour and weapon are selected from the enemy report. Smiths stand far enough back to survive but close enough for the spell's real area and range. Adding more spells is not automatically safer: fatigue, script length, and a broken line can turn valuable researchers into casualties.

Priest Smith cold-iron cell

A Priest Smith combines the paths for Iron Darts or Iron Blizzard with forging and E2 support. Black Priests can cast the same national missiles and bring H2 Inquisition. The cell requires a protected firing lane and an enemy for whom the missile profile matters. Against dispersed, resistant, or rapidly closing targets, the capital mage turn may be more valuable elsewhere.

Rare-path specialist cell

An F2, A1, E3, or S1 Master Smith is paired with the troop package and research that use that exact result. The unit receives a permanent label and a retreat plan. Rare access should not be risked merely because the spell list permits a dramatic script.

Siege column

Sappers provide Siege +5, while Master Masons provide Siege +30 and improve fort construction. Ordinary infantry supply bodies. This lets Ulm convert a production advantage into campaign tempo instead of leaving a victorious heavy army stalled at a wall. The column still needs scouts, supply, leadership, and protection against relief armies.

Ulm Pretender families

Family	What it solves	What it must not conceal
Production and economy	Converts the fort resource bonus into larger armoured queues and supports more infrastructure	Extra resources do not pay gold, recruitment points, or commander turns
Missing-path bridge	Imports Water, Death, Nature, Glamour, Blood, dependable Air, or dependable Astral	One god is not a distributed national path; site searching, boosters, and replacement access still matter
High Earth-Astral ritual bridge	Builds toward Contact Iron Angel or other late rituals	E5 S2, research, gems, and opportunity cost must all be explicit
Resistance or mobility design	Covers shock, cold, poison, MR, map-move, or another identified roster weakness	A bless affects sacred recipients, while most Ulmish troops are mundane
Awake expander	Adds early tempo where armoured troops cannot secure the required map	Afflictions, path design, and lost scales can cost more than the provinces gained

Ulm often benefits more from a missing system than from another level in paths it already recruits. The design should name the first site-search target, booster, ritual, battlefield job, and replacement

plan for every imported path. A theoretical late spell is not a reason to weaken the entire opening unless its access chain is credible.

Ulm matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Heavy conventional armour	Great weapons, Black Halberds, Destruction, Maws of the Earth, and crossbow concentration	Paying for maximum protection while using damage that cannot penetrate the target
High-Defence or shielded troops	Flails, longer weapons, attack support, control, and more frontage	Assuming protection fixes missed attacks
MR attacks and mind magic	Tempering the Will, imported Astral, resistance equipment, summons, spacing, and shorter exposure	Treating black plate as protection against MR checks
Armour-negating or armour-piercing magic	Dispersal, resistance, ranged pressure, summons, and attacks on the caster	Concentrating expensive slow troops inside the effect
Fatigue and armour destruction	Mixed armour weights, shorter fights, reinvigoration, reserves, and counter-caster pressure	Increasing armour without addressing the mechanism defeating it
Flyers and fast raiders	Guarded smiths, protected rear formations, local commanders, forts, and spies	Leaving the research and forging stack as an exposed single point of failure
Magical beings	Iron Darts or Iron Blizzard when the national profile fits, plus ordinary Earth and weapon answers	Assuming the national label guarantees favourable targeting or damage in every battle
Large units and cavalry	Pikes, layered formations, Earth control, and concentrated missile fire	Exposing unshielded pikes to the wrong ranged matchup
Strategic mobility	Fort geometry, forward laboratories, mounted command, prepared reserves, and imported mobility	Expecting slow heavy infantry to answer every raid after it appears

Monthly Ulm audit

- Which production centre is limited by resources, and which is limited by gold or recruitment points?
- Is half plate or black plate the correct marginal purchase for the current enemy?
- Are crossbows protected and assigned a target worth their slow rate of fire?
- Does every field army have a commander whose movement and leadership fit it?
- Are Master Smith randoms labelled at recruitment?
- Does the active research target have a named caster and deployment turn?
- Are Earth gems divided among battlefield use, forging, and rituals before spending begins?
- Is the capital queue solving a real religious, Mason, elite, or command bottleneck?
- Does the next fort improve recruitment geometry, resource conversion, or strategic defence?
- Is low MR being answered before the army meets mind or soul attacks?
- Are rare-path smiths protected from assassination, raiding, and routine frontline risk?
- Is a late ritual route supported by actual paths, research, and gems?

Ulm unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier deliberately leaves the following claims open:

- 1 exact expansion-party ranges for each armour and weapon mix;
- 2 live 6.36 display confirmation of the pinned Master Smith and Black Priest random masks;

- 3 final displayed item costs when national rebate, Forge Bonus, global modifiers, and rounding combine;
- 4 Iron Darts and Iron Blizzard targeting, friendly-fire, and damage outcomes in specific formations;
- 5 Tempering the Will's exact battlefield application against current MR attack types;
- 6 the economic break-even point for Sappers, Master Masons, and stronger forts on different maps;
- 7 reliable routes and payback for Contact Iron Angel and the larger Earth globals;
- 8 rider-and-mount survival outcomes for Black Knights under different attack types;
- 9 modded Ulm variants, which remain separate from this unmodded chapter.

These are preserved as unresolved claims, not converted into new test assets or guessed conclusions. R-047, R-058, and the broader runtime-testing queue remain parked until hands-on testing is explicitly resumed.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: all 37 unmodded Middle Age nation pages; national spells and rituals; research; communions, Chorus, and Grand Communion; Blood and crossbreeding; Inquisition; mounts; sailing; flying; forging; habitat transitions; and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.37, including the current Send Aatxe restriction, communion corrections, the 6.13 Forest of Avalon Magic correction, the 6.01 Abysia wall-defender note, Eriu's 6.01 terrain-recruit and Bean Sidhe corrections, Agartha's 6.04 Oracle-shape note, and 6.37's bounded research, drowning, and Drake corrections. Generic statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed nation objects.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for mage random masks, recruitment records, capital sites, national spell restrictions, national item fields, and current object cross-checks.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, path masks, costs, site income, item restrictions, and national ritual requirements are source facts. Openings, research trees, Pretender families, battlefield packages, and matchup advice are strategy. Expansion counts, random-result timing, Blood returns, crossbreeding outputs, displayed forge-cost stacking, communion and Grand Communion outcomes, hydra-field behaviour, Spell Singer outcomes, Glamour detection, special-dominion scaling and targeting, ancestor-summon behaviour, conscription output, variable summon quantities, retinue and shape behaviour, flying and storm resolution, ice-equipment scaling, Guardian Spirit behaviour, remote ritual outcomes, spell targeting, and combat outcomes remain observation questions until a versioned raw set is published.